

If you get sick in Japan

Ambulance = FREE

Call 119. It costs nothing, even for visitors.

#7119 Not sure if it's serious? Free medical advice line.

119 Life-threatening. Say "kyu-kyu desu" (It's an emergency).

日本語が話せません。
助けていただけますか。

Show this to anyone nearby. It says: I don't speak Japanese. Could you help me?

熱があります

I have a fever

お腹が痛いです

My stomach hurts



Full guide

Symptom phrases in Japanese, insurance steps, and a nurse you can message.

If you get sick in Japan

Ambulance = FREE

Call 119. It costs nothing, even for visitors.

#7119 Not sure if it's serious? Free medical advice line.

119 Life-threatening. Say "kyu-kyu desu" (It's an emergency).

日本語が話せません。
助けていただけますか。

Show this to anyone nearby. It says: I don't speak Japanese. Could you help me?

熱があります

I have a fever

お腹が痛いです

My stomach hurts



Full guide

Symptom phrases in Japanese, insurance steps, and a nurse you can message.

If you get sick in Japan

Ambulance = FREE

Call 119. It costs nothing, even for visitors.

#7119 Not sure if it's serious? Free medical advice line.

119 Life-threatening. Say "kyu-kyu desu" (It's an emergency).

日本語が話せません。
助けていただけますか。

Show this to anyone nearby. It says: I don't speak Japanese. Could you help me?

熱があります

I have a fever

お腹が痛いです

My stomach hurts



Full guide

Symptom phrases in Japanese, insurance steps, and a nurse you can message.

If you get sick in Japan

Ambulance = FREE

Call 119. It costs nothing, even for visitors.

#7119 Not sure if it's serious? Free medical advice line.

119 Life-threatening. Say "kyu-kyu desu" (It's an emergency).

日本語が話せません。
助けていただけますか。

Show this to anyone nearby. It says: I don't speak Japanese. Could you help me?

熱があります

I have a fever

お腹が痛いです

My stomach hurts



Full guide

Symptom phrases in Japanese, insurance steps, and a nurse you can message.

How healthcare works in Japan

1 Go to a clinic, not a hospital

A large hospital adds an extra fee of around ¥7,000 if you arrive without a referral. A neighbourhood クリニック is faster and cheaper.

2 Most clinics shut at lunch

Typically closed 12:00–15:00, done by 18:00, and closed Sundays. Go in the morning if you can.

3 Medicine comes from next door

The clinic gives you a prescription (処方箋). Take it to the 調剤薬局 nearby — it is only valid for 4 days.

4 Bring cash

Many clinics still do not take cards. Around ¥20,000 covers most visits.

5 Some everyday medicines are illegal here

Pseudoephedrine (Sudafed), codeine and Adderall are banned or restricted in Japan. Do not bring them in your luggage.

6 Travelling with children

#8000 is the after-hours advice line for children, in the evenings and at night.

Nurse On Call Japan — hospital accompaniment and medical interpreting for visitors in Tokyo. We are not a medical institution and do not diagnose or treat.

How healthcare works in Japan

1 Go to a clinic, not a hospital

A large hospital adds an extra fee of around ¥7,000 if you arrive without a referral. A neighbourhood クリニック is faster and cheaper.

2 Most clinics shut at lunch

Typically closed 12:00–15:00, done by 18:00, and closed Sundays. Go in the morning if you can.

3 Medicine comes from next door

The clinic gives you a prescription (処方箋). Take it to the 調剤薬局 nearby — it is only valid for 4 days.

4 Bring cash

Many clinics still do not take cards. Around ¥20,000 covers most visits.

5 Some everyday medicines are illegal here

Pseudoephedrine (Sudafed), codeine and Adderall are banned or restricted in Japan. Do not bring them in your luggage.

6 Travelling with children

#8000 is the after-hours advice line for children, in the evenings and at night.

Nurse On Call Japan — hospital accompaniment and medical interpreting for visitors in Tokyo. We are not a medical institution and do not diagnose or treat.

How healthcare works in Japan

1 Go to a clinic, not a hospital

A large hospital adds an extra fee of around ¥7,000 if you arrive without a referral. A neighbourhood クリニック is faster and cheaper.

2 Most clinics shut at lunch

Typically closed 12:00–15:00, done by 18:00, and closed Sundays. Go in the morning if you can.

3 Medicine comes from next door

The clinic gives you a prescription (処方箋). Take it to the 調剤薬局 nearby — it is only valid for 4 days.

4 Bring cash

Many clinics still do not take cards. Around ¥20,000 covers most visits.

5 Some everyday medicines are illegal here

Pseudoephedrine (Sudafed), codeine and Adderall are banned or restricted in Japan. Do not bring them in your luggage.

6 Travelling with children

#8000 is the after-hours advice line for children, in the evenings and at night.

Nurse On Call Japan — hospital accompaniment and medical interpreting for visitors in Tokyo. We are not a medical institution and do not diagnose or treat.

How healthcare works in Japan

1 Go to a clinic, not a hospital

A large hospital adds an extra fee of around ¥7,000 if you arrive without a referral. A neighbourhood クリニック is faster and cheaper.

2 Most clinics shut at lunch

Typically closed 12:00–15:00, done by 18:00, and closed Sundays. Go in the morning if you can.

3 Medicine comes from next door

The clinic gives you a prescription (処方箋). Take it to the 調剤薬局 nearby — it is only valid for 4 days.

4 Bring cash

Many clinics still do not take cards. Around ¥20,000 covers most visits.

5 Some everyday medicines are illegal here

Pseudoephedrine (Sudafed), codeine and Adderall are banned or restricted in Japan. Do not bring them in your luggage.

6 Travelling with children

#8000 is the after-hours advice line for children, in the evenings and at night.

Nurse On Call Japan — hospital accompaniment and medical interpreting for visitors in Tokyo. We are not a medical institution and do not diagnose or treat.